

Ceren F. Eser

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Substantive: Comparative Political Economy, Political Economy of Development, Distributive Politics, Historical Political Economy, State Capacity, Inequality and Redistribution, Political Behavior

Methods: Causal Inference, Experimental Design, Geospatial Analysis, Computational Social Science (LLM-based data construction)

EDUCATION

2025–present	University of California, San Diego Ph.D., Political Science	La Jolla, CA
2024	Boğaziçi University M.A., Political Science <i>Thesis: “Political Credit Cycles and the Economic Vote in Turkey”</i>	Istanbul, Turkey
2020	B.A., Economics B.A., Political Science	
2018	Sciences Po Paris Exchange Student	Paris, France

PUBLICATIONS

“Distributive Politics in Opposition: Electoral Targeting of Social Assistance in Istanbul.”
European Journal of Political Economy, 2026.

WORKING PAPERS

“Governing to Win: The Electoral Returns to Opposition Service Provision under Authoritarianism.”
Draft in preparation.

WORK IN PROGRESS

“State Capacity in the Late Ottoman Empire: An Empire-Wide Panel from Provincial Yearbooks.”

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Murat Koyuncu, Boğaziçi University 2025–present
Projects: “Effects of Affective Polarization on Consumer Preferences” (TÜBİTAK 1001 Grant) and “A Meta-Analysis of the Effects of Experimental Interventions on Affective Polarization.”

Research Assistant, Mert Arslanalp and Deniz Erkmen 2022–2023
“Resistance under Confinement: Resilience of Protests and Their Limits in Authoritarian Turkey.” Published in *Third World Quarterly*, 2024.

Research Assistant, Mine Eder, Boğaziçi University Summer 2019
“Refugee Migration and Cities: Social Institutions, Political Governance and Integration.”

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant UC San Diego
POLI 112A: Economic Theories of Political Behavior (Salam) – Winter 2026

POLI 140D: International Human Rights Law: Migrant Populations (Wong) – Spring 2026

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Boğaziçi University

Politics & Decision Theory (Taraktas) – Spring 2025
Political Science Research Methods (Taraktas) – Spring 2024, 2025
Quantitative Methods II, Graduate (Taraktas) – Spring 2024, 2025
Comparative State and Bureaucracy (Taraktas) – Spring 2024
Social Statistics (Taraktas) – Fall 2023, 2024
Advanced Research Methods, Graduate (Taraktas) – Fall 2023, 2024
Quantitative Methods I, Graduate (Taraktas) – Fall 2023, 2024
International Political Economy (Yağcı) – Fall 2023, 2024
Comparative Politics (Yağcı) – Fall 2023, 2024
Introduction to Turkish Politics (Yağcı) – Spring 2024
Political Behavior (Yağcı) – Spring 2024
Introduction to International Relations (Park) – Spring 2023
Game Theory and International Relations (Park) – Spring 2023

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

Boğaziçi University

Introduction to Programming (Öztürk, Computer Engineering) – Spring 2020
Introduction to Political Science (Yılmaz) – Summer 2019, Fall 2017

EMPLOYMENT

Teaching Assistant, Department of Political Science, UC San Diego	2025–present
Research Assistant, Department of Political Science, Boğaziçi University	2022–2025

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

Dean’s High Honor List, Boğaziçi University	2024
Dean’s Honor List, Boğaziçi University	2020
Gallagher Foundation Outstanding Success Scholarship	2015–2019

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

UC San Diego: Analytic Theory I–II, Research Design, Quantitative Methods, Math & Statistical Foundations, Comparative Politics: Institutions, Historical Political Economy, Causal Inference, Designing Field Experiments

Boğaziçi University:

Methods: Mathematical Statistics, Econometrics, Applied Microeconometrics, Quantitative Research in Political Science, Advanced Research Methods, Advanced Research Methods in Applied Economics, Qualitative Research Methods, Computational Techniques for Social Science

Mathematics: Calculus, Linear Algebra, Microeconomics, Differential Calculus, Mathematical Logic

Substantive: Game Theoretical Models of Political Economy, Comparative Politics, Political Economy of Development, Political Economics, Inequality & Economics of Distribution

SKILLS

Programming: R, Python, Stata, L^AT_EX

Computational: LLM-based data extraction and archival digitization pipelines (Python, Anthropic API)

Languages: Turkish (native), English